BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Treatment checks across the course

Relative stages, not equally spaced dates. Agree who books each check, reviews results and gives advice if a check is missed.

Check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms	dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD), blood count, kidney/liver; agree radiotherapy (RT) and tablet plan	Confirm tablet days and meal instructions	Weekly/pre-cycle bloods; bowel, skin, urine and intake review	Do not restart or make up tablets without team advice	Radiation/surgical review and management of persistent effects
Treatment review	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Tablets and radiation	Coordinate prescription, radiation bookings and transport	Twice-daily tablets on Days 1–5	No routine tablets on Days 6–7; maximum 5–6 cycles	Coordinate any tablet or radiation interruption	Completion does not mean all side effects end immediately

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00586 v3 · official regimen

Tests in your plan

Carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) — colorectal plans

If part of your plan

WHEN

For a colorectal cancer plan, if your team uses CEA; your team sets the interval.

A marker trend interpreted alongside symptoms, examination and scans.

Record the baseline, latest result and next date. A marker change alone does not establish progression.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Capecitabine + rectal radiotherapy: treatment and checks

Locally advanced rectal cancer with concurrent radiotherapy

Take capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–5 of each 7-day cycle with radiotherapy, for a maximum of 5–6 cycles. Days 6–7 are not routine tablet days. Follow the team's written instructions if radiotherapy or tablets are interrupted.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms NCCP 00586	DPD, blood count, kidney/liver; agree RT and tablet plan	Confirm tablet days and meal instructions	Weekly/pre-cycle bloods; bowel, skin, urine and intake review	Do not restart or make up tablets without team advice	Radiation/surgical review and management of persistent effects
Treatment review NCCP 00586	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Tablets and radiation NCCP 00586	Coordinate prescription, radiation bookings and transport	Twice-daily tablets on Days 1–5	No routine tablets on Days 6–7; maximum 5–6 cycles	Coordinate any tablet or radiation interruption	Completion does not mean all side effects end immediately

What each check is for

1 Confirm your personal plan

Before starting

Capecitabine tablets help pelvic radiotherapy work against locally advanced rectal cancer. Your team explains how this course fits with surgery and any other chemotherapy.

Ask / act: Agree medicines, treatment days, duration and monitoring.

Sources: NCCP 00586

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-04 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.32